

W. Johnson, then the chairman of the Massachusetts Institute of Technology. It put into words what I believed, long before I read them.

The institution must be the object of intense human care and cultivation. Even when it errs and stumbles, it must be cared for, and the burden must be borne by all who work for it, all who own it, all who are served by it, all who govern it. Every responsible person must care, and care deeply, about the institutions that touch his life.

Building a Great Organization

So, at heart, my central message begins with a sense of caring—a message reflected in these 10 rules for building a great organization, many of which, as you will see, apply to both leaders and managers.

Rule 1: Make Caring the Soul of the Organization

When I first spoke to our Vanguard crew about caring in 1989, I used these words: “Caring is a mutual affair, involving: (1) Mutual respect from the highest to the humblest among us: Each one of you deserves to be—and *will* be—treated with courtesy, candor, friendliness, and respect for the honorable work you perform. (2) Opportunities for career growth, participation, and innovation: While Vanguard is an enterprise in which so many are asked to do jobs that are routine and mundane but always essential, the simple fact is that we need your enthusiastic participation in your job—whatever it may be—if we are to make Vanguard work effectively. After all, you on the firing line know a lot more about problems and solutions than the rest of us will ever know.” The list continues: maintaining an attractive, efficient work environment; providing a meaningful communication program; and paying fair compensation. Then, I was expressing nothing more than these commonsense principles. Today, nearly 20 years later, I’m not sure I would alter a single one of